

1MC05 - MWCC - C1 - Chiltern Tunnels and Colne Valley Viaduct

Method Statement and Risk Assessment Procedure

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Handling Instructions: This procedure supersedes any previously existing procedures relating to Risk assessment and Method Statement.

Contents

Purpose	1
References	2
Method Statement Procedure	3
1.2 Responsibility for preparation and use	3
1.3 General format and content	3
1.4 Reviewing and Acceptance	3
1.5 Issue of reviewed Method Statements	4
1.6 Communication with the workforce	4
1.7 Reviews & Revisions of Existing Method Statements	4
1.8 Prevention of potential Non-Conformance	5
1.9 Records	5
Risk Assessment Procedure	6
1.10 Legislation	6
1.11 Definitions	7
1.12 Responsibilities	8
1.13 Management Plans	8
1.14 Risk Assessment	9
1.15 Risk Assessment process	9
1.16 Risk Calculation	9
1.17 Preventive Measures	10
1.18 Review of Subcontractor Risk Assessments	11
1.19 Records	11
Appendix 1 - The various steps of a risk assessment	1
Appendix 2 - Guidance Note for Method Statement and Risk Assessment Preparation.	7
Appendix 3 - RAMS Review Guidance Checklist	14

Purpose

- 1.1.1 This procedure defines the method of preparation, reviewing, and acceptance of Method Statement and Risk Assessment (RAMS) to control work activities adequately.
- 1.1.2 To ensure that all operations are reviewed, understood, and assessed to identify hazards. The risk assessment, classification of risks and preventive measures to be taken to eliminate or minimise the risks to human health, the quality of the works, communities, and the natural environments we operate in.
- 1.1.3 Method Statements and Risk Assessment are to be Project and task specific documents, which define the methods and controls to be adopted in relation to a specific element of work. They outline the Safe System of Work, of which ALIGN JV has a legal duty of care to ensure it is followed when carrying out the specified work activities.
- 1.1.4 This procedure applies to all ALIGN, Contractors and Sub- contractors' undertakings relating to Sector C1 of the HS2 programme.

References

- Method Statement (MS) Schedule 1MCo5-ALJ-QY-TEM-C001-000040;
- ALIGN Method Statement and Risk Assessment Template 1MCo5-ALJ-HS-TEM-C001-000131;
- ALIGN Environmental Management Plan;
- Appointed Person Register 1MCo5-ALJ-HS-REG-C001-000002;
- Align Appointed Persons Procedure – 1MCo5-ALJ-HS-PRO-C001-000007;
- Health & Safety Policy - 1MCo5-ALJ-HS-POL-C001-000001;
- Permit to Work systems - 1MCo5-ALJ-HS-PRO-C001-000006;
- Review Record Method Statement and Risk Assessment 1MCo5-ALJ-HS-TEM-C001-000133;
- Daily Briefing-Feedback/Feedforward form ;
- Daily Activity Briefings (DABs);
- ALIGN Suspension of Works Notification 1MCo5-ALJ-HS-FRM-C001-000103;
- Suspension of works Notification Procedure 1MCo5-ALJ-HS-PRO-C001-000011;
- ALIGN Method Statement Weekly Review Record 1MCo5-ALJ-HS-FRM-C001-000105;
- Construction Phase Health and Safety Plan 1MCo5-ALJ-CL-PLN-C001-000005;
- The Health & Safety at Work etc. Act 1974;
- The Management of Health Safety & Welfare Regulations (MHSWR) 1999;
- The Construction Design and Management Regulations (CDM) 2015;
- Electricity at Work Regulations (EWA) 1989;
- The Provision and Use of Work Equipment Regulations (PUWER) 1998;
- The Supply of Machinery (Safety) Regulations 1992;
- Personal Protective Equipment at Work Regulations (PPE) 1992;
- Lifting Operations and Lifting Equipment Regulations (LOLER) 1998;
- Control of Substances Hazardous to Health Regulations 2002;
- The Regulatory Reform (Fire Safety) Order 2005; and,
BS 5975:2008 Code of practice for Temporary Works Procedures.

Method Statement Procedure

1.2 Responsibility for preparation and use

- 1.2.1 Method Statements (MS) are produced by a member of ALIGN Management, this can be a Package Manager, Works Manager, or a subcontractor. The MS are prepared by a competent person closely involved in and knowledgeable with the scheduled activity.
- 1.2.2 Package Manager is responsible for maintaining and reviewing the Method Statement (MS) Schedule for the project to plan ahead, provide each MS with a unique document number and control timely production and review of RAMS's. Dates in the schedule are to be agreed with subcontractors at start up meeting and progress meeting.

1.3 General format and content

- 1.3.1 When a Method Statement (MS) is prepared by ALIGN, the 'ALIGN Method Statement and Risk Assessment Template' must be used.
- 1.3.2 When Method Statements are to be provided by a subcontractor, this procedure, Appendix 1 and Appendix 2 should be included in the subcontractor order.
- 1.3.3 When relevant, COSHH Assessments shall be carried out in accordance with the ALIGN Risk Assessment Procedure and any requirement for protective measures included in the MS.
- 1.3.4 Environmental Risk Assessments (ERAs) must be included in the MS where appropriate and referred to in accordance with the ALIGN Environmental Management Plan.

1.4 Reviewing and Acceptance

- 1.4.1 The Project Lead will nominate two Principal Reviewers (PR's) on the Appointed Person Register for each area, who are competent to review the Method Statement (MS). This will typically be the Package Manager and Works Manager, responsible for the work activity and subcontractor.
- 1.4.2 All Method Statements (MS) are to be reviewed by the Principal Reviewers (PR's) using the guidance in Appendix 3 and documented using the Review Record for Method Statement and Risk Assessment.
- 1.4.3 Method Statements may require to be reviewed by other key ALIGN Members this will be subject to the risks associated with the scheduled works. Guidance on this can be found in Appendix 2.

- 1.4.4 Key Align Review Members should form part of: Health and Safety Advisor or Manager, Environmental Advisor or Manager, Quality Engineer or Manager, Client representative where applicable, Consents and Stakeholder Manager.

1.5 Issue of reviewed Method Statements

- 1.5.1 All reviewed Method Statements are to be submitted using Business Collaborator.
- 1.5.2 If reviewed Method Statements for sub-contractors and Align Method Statement are issued as hard copies, the Package Manager shall reject the Method Statement and request for an electronic version to be submitted as stated within EDMS.
- 1.5.3 If the status or content of a reviewed MS is changed, the document complete with its new Review Record shall be issued at the next Revision number.

1.6 Communication with the workforce

- 1.6.1 Once the Risk Assessment and Method Statement (RAMS) have been reviewed and been Approved their content shall be communicated to the relevant members of the workforce. Signatures will record confirmation that the MS have been understood and will be followed by them, these may be recorded on the MS forms or a subcontractor MS briefing register with copies issued to ALIGN Management. Signature records and sub-contractor briefing register will need to be submitted on BC and updated whenever there are new joiners.
- 1.6.2 A member of the ALIGN team should participate on the talk at least once a month to ensure that all relevant aspects are adequately addressed. The Align member will need to record the visit on the Daily Briefing-Feedback/Feedforward form and upload it on BC.
- 1.6.3 Only after the relevant workforce has been fully informed shall the activity be allowed to commence. The initial MS briefing shall be supplemented by Daily Activity Briefings (DABs) given by a nominated supervisor to the workforce and RAMs update briefings to capture RAMs addendums.

1.7 Reviews & Revisions of Existing Method Statements

- 1.7.1 Once in place, all RAMS shall be reviewed by the PRs assigned and key Align staff (when required) whenever an incident or any significant changes occur which might affect the activity, for example:
- Incident;
 - Rework;
 - A change of key staff involved in the activity;
 - New (or updated) methodology, machinery or equipment.

- 1.7.2 Where there are no changes or incidents involved within the work activities the RAMS should still be reviewed at an interval of no more than six months from the previous review date.
- 1.7.3 All subsequent reviews are to be recorded and attached to the original version on BC and ALIGN Method Statement Review Record.
- 1.7.4 If an unsafe system of work is seen, the work shall be stopped immediately following the ALIGN Suspension of Works Notification. Work shall not be allowed to re-start until the requirements specified on the Notification are met and the RAMS are complied with. The RAMS shall be reviewed and, if necessary, revised.
- 1.7.5 On a weekly basis at least 1 Principal Reviewer shall review the RAMS with the sub-contractor to determine their relevance and to ensure adequate supervision and monitoring is in place. The weekly review will be recorded using the ALIGN Method Statement Weekly Review Record, these records will be kept internally and readily available when required.
- 1.7.6 The implementation of RAMS is subject to monitoring and surveillance.
- 1.7.7 If the RAMS need to be revised, the amendments shall be communicated to those involved via MS briefing and supplemented by DABs given by a supervisor to the workforce.

1.8 Prevention of potential Non-Conformance

- 1.8.1 To ensure prevention of non-conformance the Method Statement shall only be Approved once all the necessary steps have been taken to implement preventative/ control measures for the activity and have been incorporated in the Method Statement.

1.9 Records

- 1.9.1 The following shall be maintained (up to date, reviewed and revised) and retained as record on BC:
- Align Risk Assessment and Method Statement
 - Align Surveillance of Method Statement
 - Align RAMS briefing records and Sub-contractors' own records
 - Daily Activity Briefings records
 - Align Method Statement Weekly review record
 - Align Method Statement Review Record

Risk Assessment Procedure

- 1.9.2 Note: The assessment of risk (Risk Assessment) must be part of each method statement. This excludes the point of work risk assessment.

1.10 Legislation

- 1.10.1 Risk assessment is implied under Section 2 and 3 of the Health and Safety at Work Act 1974 that sets specific general duties to every employer to ensure, so far as is reasonably practical, the health and safety of all employees, non-employees and whoever may be affected by the work.
- 1.10.2 Risk assessments are explicitly required by the Management of Health and Safety at Work Regulations 1974 (MHSAW). The main requirement of the Management of Health and Safety at Work Act 1974 (MHSAW) is to carry out a risk assessment and record the findings of the risk assessment. Under these regulations a risk assessment should specifically include risks to new or expectant mothers, and to young persons to take account of their vulnerability. Where applicable the risk assessment will identify circumstances in which health surveillance is required to be carried out.
- 1.10.3 Although some form of risk assessment is implicit in the Health and Safety at Work Act 1974, it is the introduction of the Management of Health and Safety at Work Regulations (MHSW) and other associated legislation which has extended the duty to undertake risk assessment across all work activities which could lead to a risk to health and safety, establishing risk assessments as the foundation of health and safety management.
- 1.10.4 The requirement for suitable and sufficient risk assessment to be undertaken is incorporated in all modern UK Health and Safety Legislation and where this requirement is not identified then the requirements of MHSW prevail. In practice this means there is less defined / prescriptive legislation setting out required standards of work in health and safety law e.g., minimum guard rail height of 950mm. However, for the majority of works undertaken there is no clear or defined health and safety preventive measures.
- 1.10.5 Therefore, risks must be identified and assessed to ensure that appropriate equipment and procedures are employed, and to ensure that risks are eliminated or reduced so far as is reasonably practicable.

1.11 Definitions

Hazard

- 1.11.1 A hazard is source or situation with the potential to cause harm in terms of human injury or ill-health, damage to property, damage to environment, or a combination of this. It may be as simple as walking on uneven ground where there is a tripping hazard or cutting blocks without dust suppression, or as complex as a tandem lift with cranes where design, selection of cranes, competent supervision, ground conditions, environmental factors, stresses, etc. are all hazards involved in the operation.
- 1.11.2 The employer has a duty to examine all the operations within their control and identify the hazards associated. Having established the hazards, Project Lead, Package Manager will utilise competent personnel to assist him/her in this task. Having established the hazards priority will be given to those which are likely to cause the greatest risk

Risk

- 1.11.3 Risk is the likelihood of harm occurring and the resultant severity. It includes damage, fire, flooding, electrocution, injury, fatality, a change to the environment whether adverse or beneficial, etc. Once the hazard has been established the likely risks arising will be analysed and categorised by classifying them as high, medium or low or numerical scoring. Once categories are established the nature of risks should be further examined to establish the importance to be placed on each, for example a high risk / fatality / discharge to surface water would obviously be a major priority whilst a low risk of tripping / oil spill on hardstanding would be a minor priority, However, a low risk of fatality / discharge to surface water will always be judged to be high priority and a high risk of tripping / oil spill on hardstanding would remain a low priority.
- 1.11.4 Each case must be sensibly assessed.

Risk Assessment

- 1.11.5 The process of analysing the level of risk, considering whether hazards are adequately controlled, taking into account any measures already in place and ensuring that the precautions that are in place are suitable and sufficient to prevent them.

1.12 Responsibilities

Package Manager

1.12.1 The Package Manager / Nominee is responsible for ensuring that for each operation:

- A Risk Assessment and Method Statement are prepared, and that suitable preventive measures are included and implemented to reduce any identified risk to as low as reasonably practicable where risks can't be totally removed.
- The workforce, including Contractors/Subcontractors, have been consulted on the formulation of risk assessments and method statements and the relevant preventive measures being proposed are reiterated at daily activity briefings in addition to the initial RAMs briefings. The consultation can be carried out at the plan ahead meetings with the contractors/subcontractors. The workforce can be consulted on the preparation of RAMS at the Daily Activities briefings.
- All personnel involved in or who are likely to be affected by the work, shall be consulted at the preparation of RAMS by the Package Manager responsible for the activity. All parties will need to receive adequate instruction and communicated on the RAMS for them to carry out their task.
- Work is carried out by trained and competent personnel instructed in the requirements of the risk assessment and method statement and the proposed preventive measures.
- Competent, trained personnel are appointed to supervise work areas covered by this procedure and related work activities.
- Guidance on the minimum level of competence required can be found in Appendix 3.
- Preventive measures are reviewed on agreed timescale by Package Managers or when an incident or significant change dictates, to evaluate their on-going suitability and effectiveness. The workforce will be involved in this process via Daily Activities Briefings (any changes deemed necessary will be implemented after proposals have been evaluated for hazards and risks, the method statement and risk assessments have been updated and briefed to the workforce and if required any additional training will be carried out).

Other Personnel

- In order to fulfil their responsibilities, the Package Manager may appoint other personnel to assist them (such appointments will be recorded on the ALIGN Appointed Persons Register). These appointed persons will be responsible to the Package Manager for the implementation of the responsibilities within their appointment.
- The Package Manager is responsible to keep the Appointed Register up to date and live on BC.

1.13 Management Plans

1.13.1 The project specific Construction Phase Health and Safety Plan will identify the significant hazards associated with the construction works.

1.14 Risk Assessment

1.14.1 The Risk Assessment should show that:

- Proper checks were made
- Who and what might be affected have been identified?
- Obvious significant hazards have been dealt with, taking into account the impact on the people involved in the activity and the local environment where the activity is being undertaken.
- The precautions are reasonable, and the remaining risk is reduced to a lower level.
- Employees or their representatives have been involved in the process.

1.14.2 NOTE: Whenever an incident or any significant changes occurs which might affect the activity the Risk Assessment must be updated accordingly and at an interval of no longer than 6 months from previous revision.

1.15 Risk Assessment process

1.15.1 If your risk assessment identifies a number of hazards, you need to put them in order of importance and address the most serious risks first. Identify long-term solutions for the risks with the biggest consequences, as well as those risks most likely to cause accidents/incidents, ill health, or long-term environmental damage. You should also establish whether there are improvements that can be implemented quickly, even temporarily, until more reliable controls can be put in place.

1.15.2 Remember, the greater the hazard the more robust and reliable the measures to control the risks occurring will need to be.

1.15.3 Where we have a number of similar workplaces containing similar activities, model risk assessments reflecting the common hazards and risks associated with these activities can be produced. However, specifics of the actual work need to be included.

1.15.4 The purpose of a risk assessment is to determine and implement the preventive measures necessary to eliminate or reduce the risks associated with identified hazards. The various steps of a risk assessment are as per Appendix 1.

1.16 Risk Calculation

1.16.1 In order to determine whether a risk is High, Medium, and Low, the Risk Evaluation Matrix below, may be used or a numerical risk assessment approach.

- 1.16.2 In calculating risk, we should consider the likelihood of the event happening and the severity of the event consequences. This can be expressed in the formula:

$$\text{Risk} = \text{Likelihood} \times \text{Severity}$$

- 1.16.3 The scales can then be used to rate both the likelihood and severity as per Appendix 1.

1.17 Preventive Measures

- 1.17.1 The measures taken to eliminate/minimise risk will be entirely dependent on the nature of the risk. It is important that all risks are examined, and reasonable preventive measures taken, but it is particularly important that time is not wasted on low priority risks which could be spent on dealing with high priorities.
- 1.17.2 When assessing unusual or high-risk activities assessments must be carried out on the Risk Assessment Form. Risks within the activity are classified as High, Medium and Low, and the purpose of the assessment is to reduce the original risk by identifying preventive measures which must be followed.
- 1.17.3 The final risk level should, as far as reasonably practical, always be low but where this is not possible the original risk level, if high or medium must be reduced.
- 1.17.4 When implementing preventative and protective measure full consideration must be given to the following principles of prevention:
- If possible, avoid risk altogether (e.g., Do the works in a different way)
 - Evaluate risks that cannot be avoided by carrying out a risk assessment
 - Combat risks at source
 - Adapt work to the requirements of the individual, select work and personal protective equipment and detail safe working procedures
 - Alleviate monotonous work
 - Adapt to take account of technological and technical progress
 - Reduce those risks that cannot be prevented or avoided all together
 - Control risks
 - Use 'safe place' approaches rather than 'safe person' approaches
 - Give appropriate instructions for health and safety and environmental control
- 1.17.5 The following is intended as an example of the preventive measures which may be taken. It is not intended as an exhaustive list:
- Elimination of risk at source
 - Substitution of plant, equipment, method of work etc.
 - Choice of competent personnel

- Training
- Barriers, fences, guards, etc.
- Ventilation
- Protection from mechanical damage
- Noise barriers, dust suppression, etc.
- Method Statements
- Permit Systems

- 1.17.6 When the necessary preventive measures have been established, all personnel involved in the operation will be given information and instruction on the contents of risk assessments and method statements prior to commencement of work all personnel involved or likely to be affected will be consulted regarding their views and opinions on potential risks.

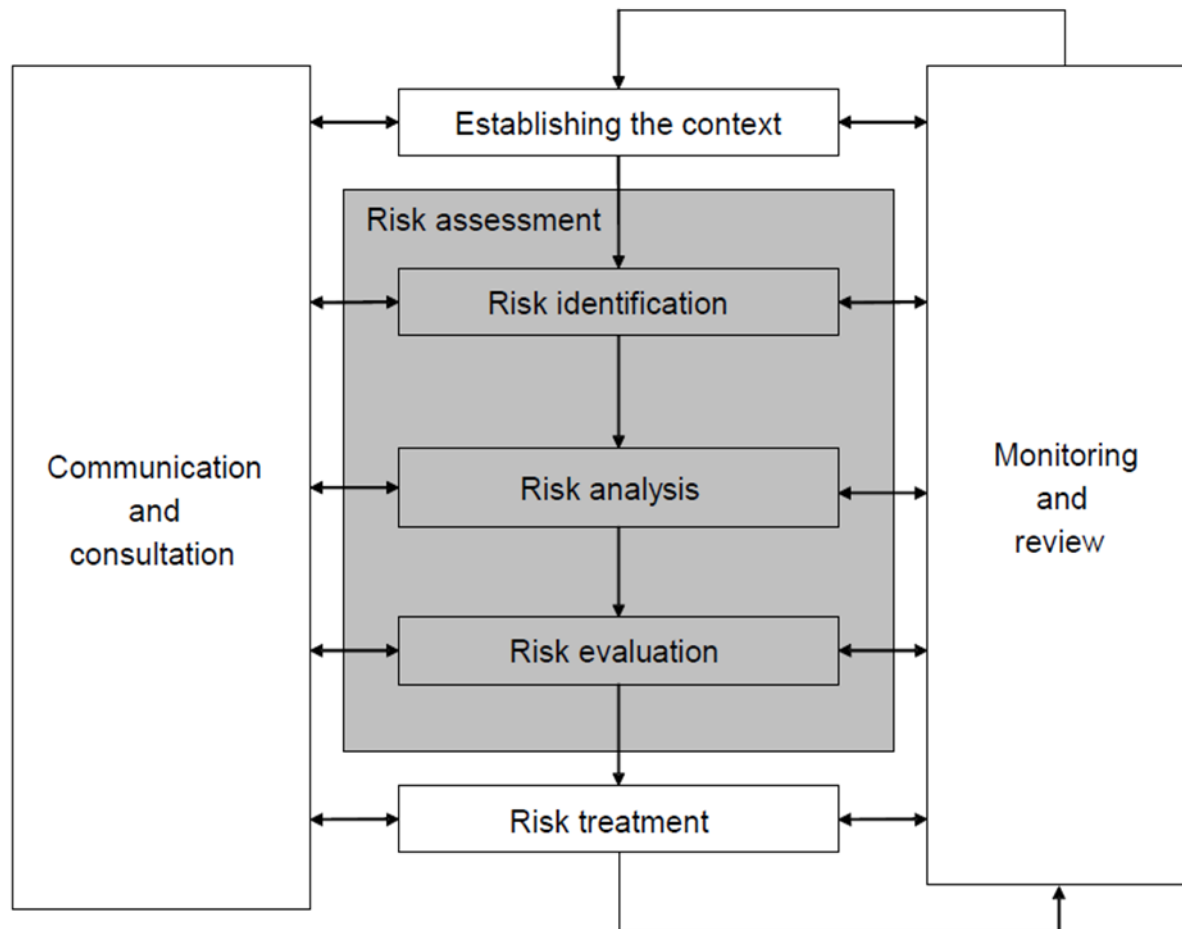
1.18 Review of Subcontractor Risk Assessments

- 1.18.1 Contractors / Subcontractors Risk Assessments and Method Statements shall be reviewed in compliance with ALIGN QMPo4 Method Statements, taking into account the significant risks identified in the Project Specific Construction Phase Health & Safety Plan. This shall ensure that there are adequate preventive measures in Contractors / Subcontractors method statements for doing the works we require of them. This process of review shall occur prior to the work package commencing on site. Time period to submit RAMS can be found in Appendix 2.
- 1.18.2 The Project Specific Construction Phase Health & Safety Plan shall be re-reviewed whenever there are significant changes within work activities and at an interval of no longer than 6 months from previous review date, to include suitable control measures identified in Subcontractors Risk Assessments or Method Statements.

1.19 Records

- 1.19.1 The following shall be maintained (up to date, reviewed and revised) and retained as record on BC.
- Align Method Statement and Risk Assessment
 - Record of Induction Training and Instruction (Daily Activity Briefings)
 - Accepted Method Statements and Risk Assessments
 - Method Statements review Record
 - Method Statements and Risk Assessments briefing sheets

Appendix 1 - The various steps of a risk assessment



STEP 1 HAZARD IDENTIFICATION	a. Make a list of routine tasks, maintenance tasks, unusual jobs, etc. to get a complete picture. Remember to think about long term hazards to health and environment (e.g., noise or exposure to harmful substances, chemical fuel spills, etc.). b. The significant hazards are those which might pose serious risks to workers, the natural environment, or other parties (including external neighbours), who might be affected by the work activity, e.g., working at height, working with chemicals, processes or substances, machinery, and asbestos, refuelling, pumping out excavations, etc. if they are not properly controlled. c. Due to the nature of construction works, the risk assessment will have to cover the broad range of risks that can be anticipated.
STEP 2 CONSIDER WHO AND WHAT MIGHT BE HARMED AND HOW	a. Identify groups at risk e.g., office staff, maintenance, contractors, visitors, public, etc. Ask others what they think the hazards may be. b. By identifying who and what might be harmed, this will identify the best way of controlling the risks. c. Some workers may have particular requirements, e.g., new, and young workers, migrant workers, new or expectant mothers, people with disabilities, temporary workers, contractors, homeworkers and lone workers
STEP 3 EVALUATE THE RISKS AND DETERMINE THE EFFECTIVENESS OF EXISTING PREVENTIVE MEASURES	a. Estimate the likelihood of events combined with the probable severity of the outcome of the risk. Draw upon experience from supervisor and/or workforce and use the Risk Evaluation matrix available within this appendix to calculate whether the residual risk is High, Medium or Low. Do not assume simply because a control exists that it is effective. b. Risk is a part of everyday life, and you are not expected to eliminate all risks. What you must do is make sure you know about the main risks and the things you need to do to manage them responsibly. You need to do everything 'reasonably practicable' to protect people and the environment from harm. This means balancing the level of risk against the measures needed to control the real risk in terms of money, time or trouble. Your risk assessment should only include

	what you could reasonably be expected to know – you are not expected to anticipate unforeseeable risks. Look at what you’re already doing and the preventive measures you already have in place. Ask yourself: 1. Can I get rid of the hazard altogether? 2. If not, how can I control the risks so that harm is unlikely? Follow the Hierarchy of Control: 1. Eliminate the Hazard – Off-site cutting, off-site prefabrication, etc. 2. Substitute the Hazard – replace ladder with scissor lift, substitute solvent-based paint with water-based paint, use hydraulic cutters instead of petrol saws. 3. Engineering Controls – Reverse alarms/lights fitted to plant, exhaust ventilation to remove fumes, dust suppression fitted to mechanical cutters, integral sumps in fuel tanks, noise barriers, petrol interceptors, etc. 4. Administrative Controls – Training, job rotation, surveillance, Toolbox talks, Spill Control Teams, workforce consultation, etc. 5. Personal Protective Equipment – Hearing Protection devices, respirators, hard hats, gloves, etc. Involve your workers, so you can be sure that what you propose to do will work in practice and won’t introduce any new hazards.
STEP 4 RECORD YOUR SIGNIFICANT FINDINGS	• There is no need to record every detail of your assessment, or how you came to your decision. The record should be enough to show that you gave proper consideration to the hazards identified and control them accordingly.

	The Risk Assessment should be documented using the Method Statement and Risk Assessment Template and following the Guidance in the appendices within this procedure. This applies to both Align and subcontractors. Note: <u>Sub-contractors may choose to use their own template, however the RAMS will need to meet the expectations within this procedure and guidance within the appendices and have Align RAMS cover for Subcontractors.</u>
STEP 5 COMMUNICATE YOUR FINDINGS	The risk assessment must be communicated to the workforce. As part of the communication/consultation process feedback may require further development. All Briefings need to be recorded using a suitable training record sheet such as the Daily Activity Briefing Template or Contractors /Sub Contractors own recording system.
STEP 6 REVIEW YOUR ASSESSMENT	- The risk assessment needs to be reviewed every six months from the previous review date and in any case where there is a sufficient material change such as, an accident/incident, near miss, introduction of new equipment or processes either directly or indirectly impinging on the work. Look at the risk assessment again and ask yourself: - Have there been any significant changes? - Are there improvements you still need to make? - Have your workers spotted a problem? - Have you learnt anything from accidents/incidents or near misses?

Risk Calculation

Scales that can be used to rate both the likelihood and severity

$$\text{Risk} = \text{Likelihood} \times \text{Severity}$$

Likelihood of occurrence	Severity of Risk / Impact
5 = Almost Certain (will definitely happen soon) that 1 or more of the risks from the activity and its hazards will occur without/with preventive measures in place	5 = Catastrophic e.g., large number of seriously injured and/or death, breach of legislation, etc.
4 = Very Likely (happens regularly and frequently) that 1 or more of the risks from the activity and its hazards will occur without/with preventive measures in place	4 = Major specified injury or illness e.g., amputation, permanent loss of sights, crush injuries etc.
3 = it is Likely (happens regularly) that 1 or more of the risks from the activity and its hazards will occur without/with preventive measures in place	3 = Serious (7 days injuries or illness) e.g., urgent medical attention, etc.
2 = Unlikely (has happened) that 1 or more of the risks from the activity and its hazards will occur without/with preventive measures in place	2 = Minor injury or illness e.g., intermittent discharge of fumes to the air from the use of plant over a short space of time or resulting in absence from work.
1 = Very Unlikely (has never happened) that 1 or more of the risks from the activity and its hazards will occur without/with preventive measures in place	1 = No injuries , etc.

From the scales above a chart can be developed, see example below, which shows the risk factor where the likelihood and severity intersect. These numerical figures can then be rated in a more comprehensible fashion as High, Medium and Low, which should be recorded on the risk assessment form.

Risk Factor (Rating) = **Low** 1-5 **Medium** 6-11 **High** - 12/25

Likelihood	Severity					
	5	5	10	15	20	25
	4	4	8	12	16	20
	3	3	6	9	12	15
	2	2	4	6	8	10
	1	1	2	3	4	5
		1	2	3	4	5

Appendix 2 - Guidance Note for Method Statement and Risk Assessment Preparation.

NOTE: This guidance is to be used by both Align and sub-contractors.

Purpose

ALIGN Management requires your Method Statements and associated Risk Assessment(s) (RAMS) and those of your sub-contractors to be specific for the task to be carried out and not generic. Your RAMS should also be concise and easily understood by your own operatives. RAMS which do not comply with the following specific requirements will not be approved for use. RAMS which are evidently far short of the stated requirements below will not be reviewed, they will be immediately rejected.

Subcontractors RAMS shall be reviewed and approved internally prior to submission onto Align for review and approve.

Failure to produce / review RAMS to an acceptable standard will be recorded within relevant KPI measures.

RAMS Approval and Submission Time

- RAMS must attain Approved status prior to any work commencing.
- RAMS should be reviewed and signed by subcontractors prior to being submitted to ALIGN Management.

A MINIMUM OF 14 WORKING DAYS IS REQUIRED FOR ALIGN TO REVIEW SUBCONTRACTORS RAMS PRIOR TO THE ACTIVITY'S

EXPECTED START DATE, THIS TIME SCALE APPLIES TO ALIGN AS WELL.

Note: the minimum submission days will differ on the scale and scope of works.

- RAMS should be produced by, or at least have input from, the person(s) who will be carrying out / supervising your work.
- Where you intend to submit a number of RAMS, you should identify them, including the dates by when they will be submitted. This is to be included within the RAMS schedule and readiness review.

Ensure your RAMS are:

- Job specific and concise, not generic.
- Written in plain English so as to be easily understood by the workforce who will be carrying out the specific element of work.
- Legible and complete. Include sketches if these help to explain the proposed methods.
- Titled, referenced and contains the revision number,
- Contains only relevant information pertaining directly to the work/s.

Explain RAMS to workforce

- Following ALIGN acceptance of the RAMS, subcontractors are required to explain their full content in manageable portions, including any comments made by ALIGN Management/ PRs and Key reviewers, to the workforce before work can start.
- Subcontractors are required to provide RAMS briefing signatures evidence to ALIGN Package Management that the operatives have fully understood it.
- Subcontractors and Align are required to carry out daily activity briefings to reinforce and refresh safe system of work.
- Where any changes to the agreed/approved RAMs are deemed necessary all updates must be approved by ALIGN Management in advance of works continuing. In some instances, this will be an addendum to the approved RAMs as opposed to a full re submission.
- All such updates will be brought to the attention of personnel engaged in the works in advance of works resuming via a RAMS briefing.

Typical Content of RAMS to include:

INTRODUCTION	GENERAL INTRODUCTION TO THE PROJECT
PURPOSE AND SCOPE	Define: • The purpose of the document • A brief description of specific elements of work that it covers • Details such as specific locations, personnel, and interfaces
REFERENCES	List documents referenced in the RAMS such as Inspection and Test Plans (ITPs), Risk Assessments, Specifications, Calculations, Drawings, and any other documents referenced within the document (contractors and sub-contractors that use other systems than Align, will need to be able to provide evidence of the references specified when required) International, European and British Standards etc.
PERSONNEL AND COMPETENCE	Details should be given of: • Name, title and responsibilities of your off-site and on-site team(s) involved in the specific task • Your key personnel (task supervisor) telephone contact details • Your first aider(s) name and telephone contact details • Evidence of you and your subcontractor's operatives' skills as verification of competence to execute the work, including recognised training certification (CSCS, CISRS, CPCS etc.) • Your on-site supervisor is required to be qualified to SSSTS or SMSTS. CVs for key duty holders

Sequence and Method of Work	Within your RAMS you should describe in sufficient but concise detail: • The specific element of work that is covered • The specific location where it applies • Your proposed sequence of working, also indicating any interfaces with other trades. • Specific equipment and materials to be used • Your proposed safe system of working to ensure that the work will be carried out in a safe manner • How you will satisfy all quality, technical, program and environmental requirements. • Measures for ensuring the workforce is adequately trained before the activity is carried out. • Details of any Temporary Works involved (including Permit to Work) and calculations to be submitted if this includes loading to existing structures METHOD OF UNLOADING/DISTRIBUTION OF MATERIALS
Emergency Response	An effective emergency response plan/statement is detailed within the Contractors RAMs suitable to deal with foreseeable emergencies arising out of the planned works.
Monitoring of Works	Arrangements for monitoring the works from a: • Safety Perspective • Environmental Perspective • Environmental Perspective • Security • Technical and Design Compliance • U&A

Compliance with ITP and Control of the Work	Within your RAMS you need to state references to ITP and how you propose to: • Comply with approved ITP during execution of the task and maintain quality records, which will verify that your works have been executed in accordance with requirements • Your methods for controlling the accuracy of your work (including setting-out) in terms of measures to prevent potentially non-conforming work If ITPs are not required as part of your scheduled works - enter N/A
Material Control and handling	Within your RAMS you need to state: • How your materials are delivered, inspected, stored, issued, handled, protected, and disposed of Any special measures which you propose to take for handling special material such as COSHH related materials
Plant Resources	You must describe your methods of carrying out your work including buildability and, where appropriate, details of principal items of plant involved, their loading, lifting capacity, location of use etc.
Security	Effective security arrangements for the work location and plant and equipment being used have been identified and effective arrangements have been detailed in accordance with the requirements of ALIGN Security Strategy Plan 1MCo5-ALJ-HS-PLN-COO1-000001.
Other	Add any other relevant requirements

Risk Assessment	This should contain your specific risk assessments for the task and state proposed control measures to be taken for addressing specific Health & Safety hazards. • Does the Risk Assessment identify the hazards (including occupational health) associated with the works? • Do the control measures adequately control the specified hazards? • Does the Method Statement identify any works which will present a risk to premises occupants, members of the public/third parties? • Does the Risk Assessment identify the control measures for the risks identified? • Does the Risk Assessment identify the risks and control measures for managing 'at risk' persons? (e.g., Young Persons, Pregnant Workers, Visitors) • Does the Risk Assessment specify the correct PPE? • Risk Assessment content conveyed to the operatives and recorded via a Daily Activity Briefing? • Is there any risk of exposure to asbestos? • Environmental aspects. • Does the Method Statement identify the environmental aspects associated with the work? E.g., generation of dust etc. • Does the Method Statement provide a schedule of specific controls for the key environmental aspects? • Has the contractor identified where aspects of the operations will have an Environmental impact (e.g., disturbance to neighbors) and which parts of the Environment will be impacted? • Have adequate arrangements been made and stated to eliminate/control these impacts? • What arrangements have been made for the ongoing reduction, minimisation, segregation, re-use, and removal of waste for recycling or disposal (Are resources for this purpose identified)?
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	• If materials/substances, have been identified which are classed as being hazardous to the environment, are suitable storage and disposal arrangements identified? • Is reference to necessary waste permits/licenses included, e.g., waste carriers and hazardous waste producers and have copies been included? • Is the frequency at which housekeeping will occur identified? • Are material movement and storage arrangements identified? • Where are concrete/cement products used has an effective wash out procedure been agreed? • What arrangements have been made for the disposal of Hazardous Waste? • What arrangements have been made to ensure surrounding water courses are not contaminated during the scheduled works? • What Environmental Controls have been made for the control of noise, vibration, and dust during the works? • Have effective control measures been identified for works upon/near contaminated land (Hydrocarbons, asbestos, Japanese Knotweed, etc.) if applicable? • Have effective control measures been identified for works which could disturb nesting birds, badgers, bats, newts, etc.? • Have effective control measures been identified for works in close proximity of trees, hedgerows, etc.? • Have hold points been identified for scheduled or unintended Archaeology remains? • Have effective control measures been identified to contain any foreseeable fuel/oil spills or similar incident? • Details of any COSHH Assessment and data sheet relevant to the element of the work, i.e., Methods of control to ensure compliance with Construction Phase Health & Safety, Fire Safety, Environmental Plans and Site Rules.
APPENDICES	

Appendix 3 - RAMS Review Guidance Checklist

This Method Statement and associated Risk Assessment(s) (RAMS) review checklist has been included specifically to give additional guidance on typical items that are expected to be contained in the RAMS. This guidance should be taken into account when reviewing the RAMS and completing a Method Statement and Risk Assessment Review Record. They will be most useful for less experienced members of ALIGN Project Team.

The purpose of a RAMS review is to:

- Assess the adequacy of the RAMS and accompanying documentation to ensure a safe system of work is adopted.
- Ensure the works are delivered to the required standards i.e., Specification, Environmental and Health & Safety guidelines, and legislative requirements.

Note: The below checklist should be used alongside Appendix 2

Review Checklist				
Method Statement and Risk Assessment				
1	Introduction	General Introduction to the Project		
2	Purpose and Scope of Works	Is the work location clearly identified for the activities described?		
		Is there a requirement for the Method Statement to be reviewed and approved by the employer or a third Party? (ALIGN to issue to the external party following their review)		
		Definitions to be included for any special terminology, equipment, acronyms, etc. Note: Comments received from the employer or third party to be incorporated in ALIGN review record.		
3	References (Specification / Calculations / Drawings, etc.)	Are references made to the relevant clauses of the specification, relevant contract drawings, subcontractor's design drawings and any design calculations?		
4	Personnel and Competence	Supervision / Workforce	Are Supervisors identified by name and job title?	
			Is provision included for First Aid?	
			Are other significant persons with specific responsibilities, i.e., first aider, fire watch etc., identified?	
			Are there sufficient supervisors identified to manage the work?	
			Are sufficient numbers of employees indicated to enable the work to be carried out safely within the indicated time scales?	
			Are there personnel and arrangements in place in the event of an emergency, e.g., work at height rescue, confined space rescue, material / pollution incident, etc.?	
			Occupational Health – Are all employees fit for work? (Ensure evidence received).	
		Training / Competence	Is specific training identified as required for the activities included in the Method Statement?	
			Are the contractors, including their supervisors, trained and competent, to the required standard for those activities? E.g., 5 Day SMSTS or 2-day SSSTS (ensure evidence received) To include CVs for key duty holders	
5	Sequence and Method of Work	General	Is the method of work described in sufficient detail to allow the work to be clearly understood and carried out in accordance with the Specification and drawings?	
			Does the sequencing of the work tie in with the contract programme?	
			Have particular emergency plans been detailed in the safe method of work?	
			Are effective controls identified to comply with location specific U&A's?	
			Does the method of work include reference to on-going checks by the Supervisor of the work to ensure compliance with the specified requirements?	
			Are appropriate manufacturer's instructions attached?	

Review Checklist				
			Are necessary sketches / service drawings attached? E.g., concealed utility services	
			Have site conditions and working environment been addressed?	
		Temporary Works	Does the RAMS identify any Temporary Works required in the execution of the work i.e., trench support, falsework, propping, etc.?	
			Are Temporary Works design drawings, calculations attached?	
			Does the RAMS identify who is responsible for ensuring the Temporary Works scheme is designed and installed correctly and if they are suitably qualified?	
			Has the contractor identified the means for recording inspections of Temporary Works installation, permission to load, and permission to dismantle?	
			Permits to Work	
			Are all hot works identified, where applicable?	
			Are there fire prevention arrangements in place where hot works are being undertaken?	
			Are all excavation works identified, where applicable (working within 1m of live services)?	
			Is all work at height identified, where applicable?	
			Are all electrical works identified, where applicable?	
			Are all confined space works identified, where applicable (this includes manholes/sewers, especially where live)?	
6	Emergency Response	An effective emergency response plan/statement is detailed within the Contractors RAMs suitable to deal with foreseeable emergencies arising out of the planned works		
7	Monitoring of Works	Safety Perspective		
		Environmental Perspective		
		Security		
		Technical and Design Compliance		
		U&A's		
8	Compliance with ITP and Control of the Work	Does the RAMS include references to Inspection and Test Plan?		
		Does the RAMS identify inspections, hold points to be carried out in accordance with the Specification, including the frequency?		
		Does the RAMS (or ITP) identify tests to be carried out in accordance with the Specification, including the frequency and reference to method of testing?		
		Does the RAMS (or ITP) identify who is responsible for carrying out and signing off inspections and tests?		
		Does the RAMS (or ITP) identify hold points, their method of release and the person authorised to sign them off?		

Review Checklist			
		Does the RAMS (or ITP) identify checklists and / or sign off sheets to be used to record inspections, tests and hold point release?	
		Does the RAMS (or ITP) identify the method for notifying ALIGN site staff that the works are complete and ready for inspection?	
		Does the RAMS (or ITP) include a checklist for recording the completion inspection and any outstanding, or defective work?	
		Does the RAMS (or ITP) identify who is responsible for carrying out the final inspection prior to the work being inspected by ALIGN Management?	
9	Material Control and Handling	Has a schedule of materials/substances to be used been provided?	
		Does the RAMS identify materials/substances which are classed as being hazardous to health as per COSHH Regulations?	
		Does the RAMS identify materials/substances which are classed as highly flammable?	
		Does the RAMS identify materials/substances, which are classed as being hazardous to the environment, and also suitable method of storage to prevent pollution?	
		Are the Hazardous Substances identified covered by a COSHH Risk Assessment?	
		Have the contents of COSHH Assessments been communicated and recorded via a Daily Activity Briefing to the operatives?	
		Are material datasheets or technical information sheets included for all hazardous substances?	
		Are materials which give rise to Special and/or Hazardous Wastes identified, together with the project-specific manner of disposal, in accordance with the current Waste Regulations?	
		Does the RAMS include details of how materials are to be delivered, off-loaded, stored to prevent damage, loss or deterioration due to adverse weather conditions, and transported around site to the installation point?	
		Does the RAMS identify who is responsible for off-loading and onward movement of materials/equipment?	
		Safe access for materials delivery	
		Unloading areas for materials	
		Alternative access	
		Restrictions on delivery times	
		Information on height or weight restrictions	
		Fall prevention if access to delivery vehicle is needed	
10	Plant Resources	Plant	
		Does the Method Statement contain a schedule of plant and equipment to be used?	
		Does the Method Statement contain a system for providing all relevant statutory test / examination certification (ensure evidence received before plant is allowed to be used, e.g., pre-Delivery Inspection Checklist and Thorough Examination Certificates)?	
		Is there a Schedule of any specialist equipment to be used in connection with the work?	

Review Checklist			
		Is there provision of relevant training/competence certificates for plant/equipment operators e.g., CPCS, IPAF etc. (ensure evidence received)?	
		Does the method statement include provision for regular plant maintenance, including frequency, etc.?	
		Are there details of lighting to be provided e.g., Task Lighting (must be sufficient), intrinsically Safe Lighting, and Emergency Lighting, where appropriate?	
		Is there confirmation that fuels and oils will be stored in accordance with Control of Pollution (Oil Storage) (England) Regulations 2001 and relevant Pollution Prevention Guidelines, where applicable?	
		Are refuelling and spill response controls identified, where applicable?	
		Are suitable drip trays and spill kits to be provided, where applicable?	
		Have quieter tools / machines been selected to reduce exposure to noise?	
		Have tools with reduced vibration levels been selected to reduce HAVS?	
		Has the situation of plant/equipment been assessed? Is there enough space to allow safe working to take place around plant/equipment? Will any platform be strong enough to take the weight of equipment, materials and operatives?	
		Have tools / equipment been selected to reduce manual handling activities?	
		Power Supplies	
		Is there provision being made for power and is it suitable namely: Gas	
		Electric (110v unless under exceptional circumstances and justified by Risk Assessment)	
		Compressed air	
		Working Platforms / Access Above Ground Level	
		Will any type of working platform be used, e.g., Scaffolding/MEWP/Mobile Scaffolding/Ladders?	
		Does the scaffolding need to be designed by a specialist or is it a standard scaffold?	
		Has provision been included for the safe erection of the working platform by competent trained personnel, where necessary e.g., CPCS, IPAF, PASMA, etc. (ensure evidence received)?	
		Has the person who is responsible for erection and inspection of the working platform been identified and appropriate training records included?	
		Are there provisions to protect against erectors falling from height e.g., handrails, and safety harnesses?	
		Is there a provision included for Access/Egress to/from the working platform, where applicable?	
		Are there arrangements for Maintenance, Inspection and Reporting outlined (especially Scaffolding/Mobile Scaffolds / Harnesses which must be inspected every 7 days when erected)?	
		Has provision been included for the safe use and fitting of safety harnesses where applicable?	

Review Checklist			
		Are those using harnesses trained in their use?	
11	Security	Effective security arrangements for the work location and plant and equipment being used have been identified and effective arrangements have been detailed in accordance with the requirements of ALIGN Security Strategy Plan 1MC05-ALJ-HS-PLN-COO1-000001.	
12	Other (Programme)	Is there an indication of the Duration of programme – Start Date and Completion Date?	
		Does the Method Statement include reference to any sectional completion dates, if applicable?	
		Are there any restrictions on hours of work? E.g., nightshift work, close to residential areas	
	Other Design Resources	Is the subcontractor’s designer identified by name, if applicable?	
		Are there sufficient design resources identified	
		to complete design of the works, if applicable?	
	Other Control of own Subcontractors	Does the Method Statement identify any sub-subcontractors employed to carry out the work?	
		Is a copy of the sub-subcontractor’s Method Statement and Risk Assessments included as part of the main Method Statement?	
		Has the sub-subcontractor’s Method Statement been reviewed by the sub-contractor prior to forwarding to ALIGN Management and does it contain all necessary controls to ensure compliance with statutory and contract requirements?	
		Are communication routes between ALIGN Management and the sub-subcontract labour clearly defined?	
	Other Measuring & Test Equipment	Does the Method Statement contain a schedule of measuring and testing equipment to be used and any specific training requirements for operatives using the equipment?	
		Does the Method Statement contain a system for providing all relevant calibration certificates and / or test / examination certification, as required (ensure evidence received)?	
		Does the Method Statement contain evidence of any specific training provided for operatives using the equipment?	
13	Risk Assessment	Does the Risk Assessment identify the hazards (including occupational health) associated with the works?	
		Do the control measures adequately control the specified hazards?	
		Does the RAMS identify any works which will present a risk to premises occupants, members of the public/third parties?	
		Does the Risk Assessment identify the control measures for the risks identified?	
		Does the Risk Assessment identify the risks and control measures for managing ‘at risk’ persons? (E.g., young persons, pregnant workers, visitors)	
		Does the Risk Assessment specify the correct PPE?	
		Risk Assessment content conveyed to the operatives and recorded via a Daily Activity Briefing?	
		Is there any risk of exposure to asbestos?	

Review Checklist			
		Does the RAMS identify the environmental aspects associated with the work? E.g., generation of dust etc.	
		Does the RAMS provide a schedule of specific controls for the key environmental aspects?	
		Has the contractor identified where aspects of the operations will have an environmental impact (e.g., disturbance to neighbours) and which parts of the environment will be impacted?	
		Have adequate arrangements been made and stated to eliminate/control these impacts?	
		What arrangements have been made for the ongoing reduction, minimisation, segregation, re-use and removal of waste for recycling or disposal? (Are resources for this purpose identified)	
		If materials/substances, have been identified which are classed as being hazardous to the environment, are suitable storage and disposal arrangements identified?	
		Is reference to necessary waste permits/licenses included, e.g., waste carriers and hazardous waste producers and have copies been included?	
		Is the frequency at which housekeeping will occur identified?	
		Have material movement and storage arrangements been identified?	
		Where concrete/cement products are used, has an effective wash-out procedure been agreed?	
		What arrangements have been made for the disposal of hazardous waste?	
		What arrangements have been made to ensure surrounding water courses are not contaminated during the scheduled works?	
		What environmental controls have been made for the control of noise, vibration and dust during the works?	
		Have effective control measures been identified for works upon/near contaminated land (Hydrocarbons, asbestos, Japanese Knotweed etc.) if applicable?	
		Have effective control measures been identified for works which could disturb nesting birds, badgers, bats?	
		Have effective control measures been identified for works in close proximity of trees, hedgerows etc.?	
		Have hold points been identified for scheduled or unintended Archaeology remains?	
		Have effective control measures been identified to contain any foreseeable fuel/oil spills or similar incident?	
		Details of any COSHH Assessment and data sheet relevant to the element of the work. Methods of control to ensure compliance with	
		Construction Phase Health & Safety, Fire Safety	